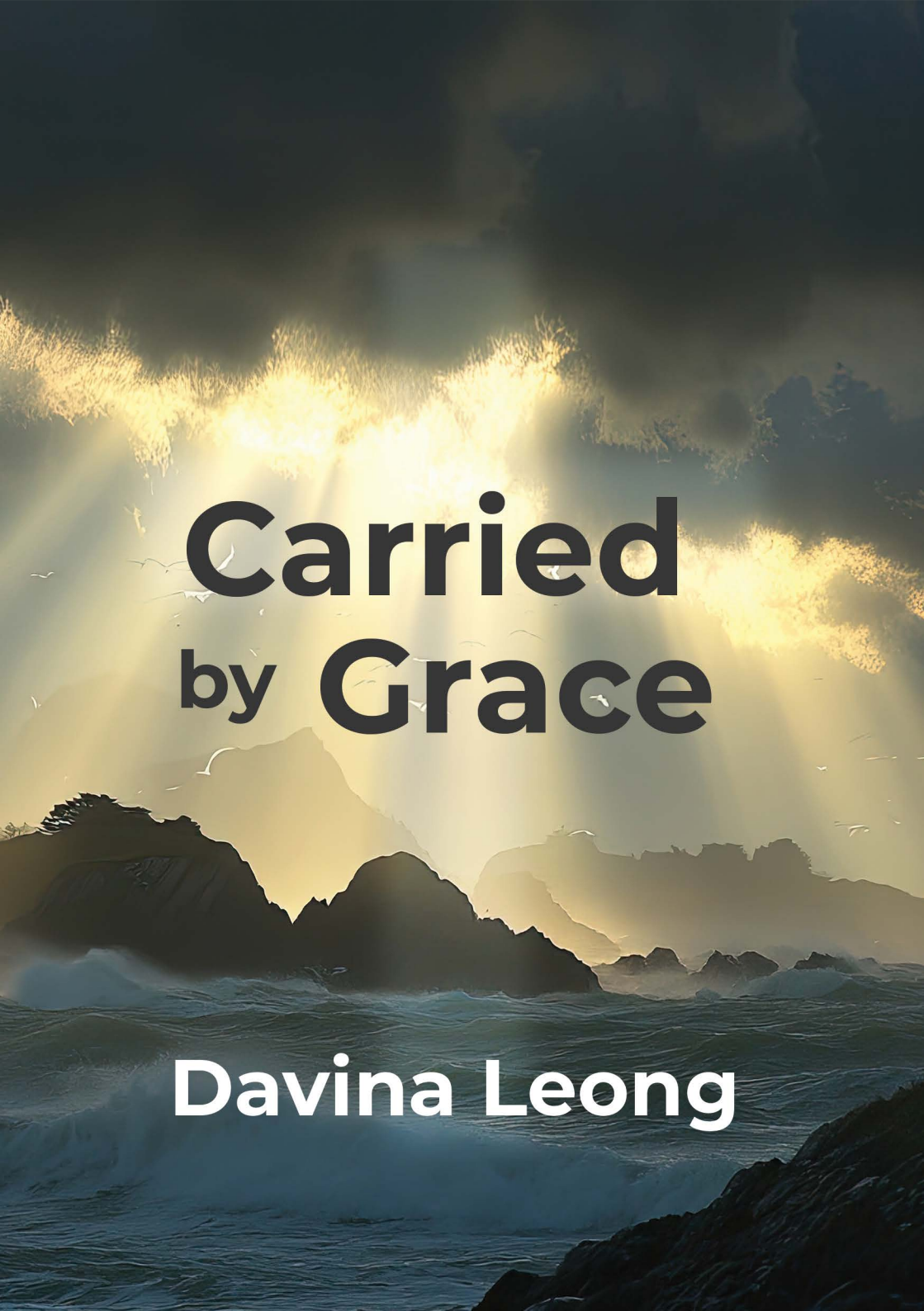




Carried by Grace

Davina Leong

This is a story of grace, struggle, and restoration.

From academic pressure to mental battles, from moments of weakness to seasons of breakthrough—through it all, one truth remained constant: Jesus is faithful.

In this personal testimony, Davina shares how the Lord carried her through life's highs and lows, restored her mind, and led her into purpose.

No matter where you are in your journey, His grace is sufficient—and His faithfulness never fails.

Carried by Grace

My Journey with Jesus

I was born into a typical Christian Asian family in Singapore. My dad was your typical Asian father, while my mother was a strict, yet easy-going Peranakan auntie.

I was introduced to computers through my father at a very young age. I still remember playing MS-DOS games on those boxy CRT computers and storing data on diskettes in the 1990s. Wow! How far technology has advanced over these several decades!

Anyway, I was never the studious type. This made me the odd one out among my cousins. While I had no siblings, my aunties and uncles would always

compare our academic achievements. And when I was 15, I knew I wanted to do something practical and computer-related. As I played a lot of computer games back then, I wanted to become a video games developer.

So, despite my average grades, I managed to get into an IT diploma course at a local polytechnic through a special programme that considered students' skills beyond academic qualifications. But to me, it was a heavenly wink from Jesus. I mean, I think I was one of the first batch of students to be enrolled through this programme.

Polytechnic was fun, and I did pretty well. By the grace of Jesus Christ, I led my Final Year Project team to success. Not only did we all score an A for it, but we got Gold for the institution's project exhibition. Through this experience, Jesus also taught me leadership, including how to manage a difficult team member.

After that, I planned to work for a while, as I enjoyed the culture at my workplace and couldn't find the time to prepare the documents needed to enrol at a private technology university, a reputable American university in the video games industry. But, here was another heavenly from my big, big, Daddy God! Sometime in

April/May 2011, my mother chanced upon a newspaper article reporting that the university had extended its intake period to the end of June. My mother pushed me, and I applied for the Bachelor of Arts in Game Design programme and, by His grace, got in.

The university was a VERY challenging degree for me. I felt the learning and achievements at the polytechnic were too basic. But I set my mind to see it through. At first, I was scraping through. I failed a core module, which resulted in a one-year extension.

All the while, the university's high standards led me to keep turning to

my Lord Jesus for help, comfort, and supply. My most frequent prayer was, "Help me, teach me, show me." I kept attending all church services as they were the nourishment I needed. If not, I know that I would have gone crazy from the immense stress.

But, by His grace, I found myself excelling eventually. Suddenly, everything clicked, and I was able to finish courses such as English, Videography, Math, Psychology, Digital Art, Traditional Art, and 3D modelling, to name a few. All I knew was that that knowledge and understanding were not natural but supernatural. Supernaturally supplied by my Lord and Saviour, Christ Jesus.

However, in 2014, everything came crashing down. Second week in, and I felt a mental oppression on my mind. Suddenly, all the coding and logic I had learned over six years disappeared, and I struggled to complete any of my coding assignments. But I thank Jesus that I was able to complete my immersion programme, during which I spent 3 months at the university's overseas campus in Washington, US. There, I also attended a church, pastored by a well-known pastor. Jesus already knew what I was going through and caused a well-known pastor from an international church to preach at one of the services I attended! Wow! Thank

You, Lord! Only You foreknew what was going to happen and orchestrated everything for me!

But, alas, due to health reasons I was unable to complete my degree and left the university in October 2014. But, not before seeking the Lord about the situation. I told the Lord, "Lord, You see and know everything. You know that I feel dead here." He replied, "Whether you stay or go, I will take care of you." But I knew in my heart that He was more inclined to let me leave with only about 2-3 modules to complete.

Paper qualifications aside, I picked up many life skills during my university

studies. Some of them were time management, project scoping, teamwork, and even learning to be independent while studying overseas—skills that can't be taught. Looking back, that was probably my training with my Lord Jesus.

Anyway, 2015 started out difficult for me. I came out of 2014 with low self-esteem, little strength, and suicidal tendencies and suffering from mental oppression. I approached two pastors at the church I attended for prayer, guidance, and clarity. But "when I am weak, then I am strong." 2 Cor 12:10. Because Jesus, through my mother, gave me a position of blessing at a private company. A miracle

considering that I had a handicapped mind.

There, the Lord used my time at that company (an IT company) and other IT companies to restore my mind, acquire knowledge and gain experience in web development.

Besides that, I also continued to build my design skills. Over the years, Jesus gave me the grace to build my own website and side projects to use as a portfolio for job interviews.

After that, I moved on to another company, where I had this conversation with the Lord while working on a challenging task. He asked me, "They say I don't know anything about computers. What do

you say?" I said, "But, Lord, all things come from You. The idea of computers came from You." Then, He just smiled at me.

I also started attending technology conferences, where I learned about the IT meetups in Singapore. Arrowed, I was asked to speak at a local developer community, where I gave a talk on my weight-loss journey and how I take care of my well-being as a software developer. Disclaimer: I'm not a certified medical professional. I was sharing some tips I practise to stay healthy as a programmer. Then I gave another talk on a CMS platform at a PHP meetup.

In 2020, I got a position at a digital solutions company. Heh heh, my heavenly Daddy has certainly set me apart from the world. Because while everyone else was facing challenges during the COVID-19 period, my big, big Daddy God not only promoted me to a bigger company but also increased my salary! During my time there, I faced many challenges at work, but I learned to ask Jesus for His supply and guidance. I consistently completed my projects on time, received compliments from my colleagues and the head of the department, such as "little bugs" and "exponential performance".

Later, when I moved on to another company, a client whom my colleagues feared because he always scolded them complimented me. This same client praised me in front of my boss after I finished setting up the payment system on his WordPress website, and my boss said, "That's why we hired her!"

That's not all. When I landed a position at a global investment organisation, I received compliments from the vendor and the internal clients I worked with, too.

All glory goes to Jesus. The verse I kept meditating on and holding on to

during these several years was
Proverbs 22:29 NKJV:

29 Do you see a man who excels in his
work?

He will stand before kings;

He will not stand before unknown
men.

I was meditating on excellence
through Christ Jesus. As an employee,
I'm serving. But as a Christian, I serve
my employers by delivering excellent
work. When people meet [Author], I
don't want them to see [Author]. I
want them to encounter my Lord and
Saviour, Christ Jesus. I want to share

the beauty of His love and grace with those around me. I may not be perfect, but man, do I want to be like my Lord Jesus by the transformation of His grace, amen.

Anyway, politics at that organisation caused me to leave my position without another job yet. Then, my health took a turn for the worse in 2024. I started hearing voices. They sounded like the voices of those whom I highly esteem in church, which made them very hard to ignore. And initially, I didn't know what was going on either, so I kept obeying the voices. Through the grace of Christ Jesus, I earned two to three certificates in UX Design, AI, and Cybersecurity

from a training institute. But I still kept trusting the Lord to give me a job. I even went so far as to go to fast food restaurants to look for a source of income.

But my Daddy God was so loving and encouraging. Because He sent so many Christian brothers and sisters from all ages and denominations to help, pray and encourage me! First, there was my own care group, who made me a sticky notes board—special thanks to my bestie in Christ for leading the initiative. Then my mother's mutual church friend introduced us to a private psychiatrist who was able to treat me in the way that suited my personality. My parents also found a church that was always

open for prayer, and we went there frequently despite my tantrums (ha-ha, thank you, mum and dad, for putting up with me!). Besides that, we were introduced to an online Christian ministry that met every Thursday night for prayer. I also approached my own church for prayers.

Personally, I experienced the tremendous power of praying in the Spirit (or tongues), of anointing oil, and of speaking the word over myself. I could sense a cool watery halo all over my brain when I prayed in tongues. When the disturbing thoughts and voices come, I would quote Psalm 23 over myself. My mother would also anoint me and my pillow, too!

While I haven't found a job yet in 2025, I saw a TV commercial about a career fair happening at a major convention centre. There, I got wind of a more sophisticated course—a business data and analytics programme. Not only did I get a distinction in the course, but also in all 3 modules: SQL, Python, and Machine Learning! Wow! Never in my wildest dreams did I think I would achieve such a result! Only by the grace of Christ Jesus!

Not only that, but my Lord, Saviour, and Bestest Best Friend gave me a position at an enterprise software company serving a local government agency. There, the skills and knowledge I acquired from the course

were put to good use. I made an AI chatbot that integrated with the enterprise software. I learned to install software on my work laptop and work with proprietary programming languages, which strengthened my technical expertise. And by the end of 2025, Jesus will have fully restored my mind.

In 2026, I left that company to found my own software company. A company founded by the grace of Christ Jesus. Jesus is the CEO. I am just the steward. He is my Business Partner. As my namesake said, I'm not giving to Jesus, but giving back to Him out of all that He has given and blessed me with (1 Chr 14:19)

What more great adventures does my
Lord Jesus have in store for me? For
Him to know and for me to find out,
amen!